



JIGME WANGCHUK (Mr.)

Senior Forestry Officer
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Professional Summary

Forestry and conservation professional with expertise in biodiversity conservation, forest fire resilience, and ecosystem management in Bhutan. Bringing nearly seven years of experience in translating conservation policies into practical action, coordinating with government and partner agencies, and conducting applied research using GIS, remote sensing, and field-based monitoring. Passionate about sustainable forest management, protecting high-value ecosystems, and working with local communities to support long-term conservation and responsible stewardship of Bhutan's natural resources.

Educational Background

- B. Sc. in Forestry – College of Natural Resources, Royal University of Bhutan, Lobesa, 2015 – 2019, *Thesis: Diversity and Distribution of Coccinellids under Different Habitats in Zhemgang Dzongkhag*
- BHSEC (Class XII), Science – Gongzim Ugyen Dorji Higher Secondary School, Haa Bhutan, 2014
- BCSEA (Class X), General – Wangchhu Middle Secondary School, Chukha Bhutan, 2012

Work Experience (s)

Senior Forestry Officer – Forest Fire and Pest Management Programme | Forest Resources Planning and Management Division, Department of Forests and Park Services, Thimphu, Bhutan
January 2026 – Present

- Lead and coordinate national efforts in strengthening forest fire and pest management programme across Bhutan.
- Develop and implement technical guidelines, frameworks, and management approaches for forest fire prevention, preparedness, response, and forest pest management.
- Monitor and evaluate forest fire management activities and assess pest and disease-affected forest areas to identify emerging risks and recommend appropriate interventions.



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- Coordinate fire management and pest mitigation initiatives to build the ecological resilience of the forests.
- Provide technical guidance, capacity development, and field-level support to forestry professionals and institutions on forest fire and pest management.
- Design and undertake technical and policy research to identify innovative, evidence-based approaches to emerging forest fire and pest management challenges.
- Provide technical advice and expert inputs to the Department and Ministry to support policy development and informed decision-making on forest fire management.
- Identify and propose measures to reduce the impacts of forest fires, strengthen preparedness and safety, and improve resilience in fire-prone and fire-sensitive areas.
- Support resource mobilisation and coordination of funding for forest fire prevention, mitigation, preparedness, and response initiatives.
- Contribute technical expertise and reporting towards Bhutan's international commitments and obligations related to forest fire management, biodiversity conservation, and climate change.
- Project focal for *Restoring Fire-Damaged Ecosystems and Enhancing Wildland-Urban Interface Resilience in Bhutan* funded by AFoCO (July 2026 – June 2030)

Senior Forestry Officer – Divisional Forest Office, Dagana under the Department of Forests and Park Services, Dagana, Bhutan

January 2025 – December 2025

- Head, Forest Resources Planning and Management Section / IKI Focal
 - Directed planning, monitoring, and management of forest resources in Dagana.
 - Coordinated research and field-based monitoring, including wildlife and fish diversity studies.
 - Managed high conservation value (HCV) areas and facilitated community forestry initiatives.
 - Contributed to management effectiveness tracking (METT+) and applied GIS/remote sensing for decision-making.

Forestry Officer – Divisional Forest Office, Dagana under the Department of Forests and Park Services, Dagana, Bhutan

January 2020 – December 2024

- Headed the Forest Resources Planning and Management Section, overseeing national and regional projects including IKI Living Landscape Project, UNEP SAFE Project, BTFEC Project, and APA initiatives.
- Served as Range Officer of Lhamoizingkha Range for six months, managing field operations and community engagement.
- Led Social Forestry and Extension Section activities, including community forestry program planning and capacity-building.



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- Conducted field-based research and monitoring, including wildlife surveys, fish diversity assessments, and HCV area management.
- Applied GIS and remote sensing for spatial analysis to support evidence-based decision-making and conservation planning.

Project Management and Key Positions

- Focal officer for International Centre for Integrated Mountain Development (ICIMOD) – Himalayan Resilience Enabling Action Programme (HI-REAP)
 - Implementation of the project component on promoting nature-based solutions for sustainable rangeland management, and
 - Conducted a prescribed burning pilot exercise to address weed and invasive-species encroachment in rangelands and mitigate climate-change impacts.
- National Taskforce Member for Community Security Skilling (CSS) Component of the National Gyalsung Project
 - Act as the departmental focal officer for forest firefighting training, overseeing planning, coordination, and implementation of initiatives related to the forest firefighting course.
 - Successfully developed a competency-based curriculum and comprehensive training manual for forest firefighting training under the Gyalsung programme.
- Focal Officer for the Project titled, “Restoring Fire-Damaged Ecosystems and Enhancing Wildland-Urban Interface Resilience in Bhutan” funded by AFoCO
- Technical Working Group member for Rangeland Development in Bhutan
- Technical Working Group member for Locally Led Adaptation (LLA) programme
- Technical Working Group member for Pest Risk Analysis for 24 timber species identified for export from Bhutan
- Technical Working Group member for the development of project proposal for Adaptation fund – Large Innovation Grant window
- Technical Working Group member for the FAO’s Global Firehub project proposal development in context to Bhutan

Publications / Reports

- Divisional Forest Office Management Plan for Divisional Forest Office, Dagana, 2026
- Conflicts to Co-existence (C2C) Strategy for Lhamoizingkha Gewog, 2026
- Conflicts to Co-existence (C2C) Strategy for Trashiding Gewog, 2026
- A Pictorial Guide to the Freshwater Fishes of Dagana, 2025
- Carnivores recorded in Sakteng Wildlife Sanctuary, Bhutan – *Journal of Animal Diversity*, 2025



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- Diversity and Distribution of Ladybird Beetles (Coleoptera: Coccinellidae) under Different Habitats in Zhemgang, Bhutan – *Bhutan Journal of Natural Resources & Development*, 2024
- Socio-economic Status and Climate Vulnerability of Divisional Forest Office, Dagana, 2024
- Rapid Biodiversity Assessment Report for Dagana, 2023
- Forest Fire Fighting Training Manual for Gyalsung, 2023
- Curriculum on Forest Firefighting for Gyal-Suung, 2022
- Six Species of Coccinellidae New to Bhutan (Insecta: Coleoptera) – *Oriental Insects*, 2021

Certifications & Training

- Remote Sensing of Wildfire Management – United Nations University Institute for Water, Environment and Health (UNU-INWEH), Dec 2025
- Introduction to Other Effective Area-based Conservation Measures (OECMs): UNDP & WWF-US, Dec 2025
- The Science of Well-Being – Yale University, Feb 2025
- Andragogy (Training & Teaching) – Department of Forests and Park Services, Apr 2024
- Climate Change Vulnerability Assessment Training for the IKI Living Landscape – 20 till 25 Nov 2023
- Development of Curriculum on Forest Fire Management for Gyal-Suung Cadets – Department of Forests and Park Services, Sept 2023
- Workshop on Reduced Impact Logging (Cable Crane Assisted Logging Operations) – 22–25 Sept 2025
- Hydrogeology and Springshed Management – Department of Forests and Park Services, Apr 2022
- Watershed Analysis using GIS – Udemy, Oct 2021
- Integrated Basic Arms and Drill Training – Military Training Center, Bhutan, Oct 2020
- Foundational Inservice Training for Technical Service – Royal Institute of Management, 2020
- Basic integrated fire management tools for early warning and decision-making – Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations e-learning Academy, 2026
- Agroforestry for sustainable agrifood transformation: Introduction – Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations e-learning Academy, 2026
- Agroforestry 101: Enhancing Livelihoods and Ecosystem Resilience – RECOFTC, March 10 – May 11, 2026

Conferences & Workshops Attended

- Regional Model Forest Network at Paro, Bhutan, 2026
- Reduced Impact Logging (Cable Crane Assisted Logging Operations) in Germany, 2025



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- Climate Change Vulnerability Assessment Training for the IKI Living Landscape in Nepal, 2023
- MKCF knowledge sharing workshop in Cambodia and Vietnam, 2026

Languages

- Dzongkha: Native, Fluent (speaking, reading, writing)
- English: Fluent (speaking, reading, writing)
- Hindi: Conversational
- Nepali: Conversational

Skills and Technical Expertise

Technical Skills

- Geospatial Analysis: Proficient in GIS (ArcGIS, QGIS) and remote sensing for spatial mapping, forest fire risk assessment, and biodiversity monitoring.
- Data Analysis: Skilled in statistical analysis using R and Excel, including ecological data interpretation and visualization.
- Field Survey & Monitoring: Extensive experience in field-based surveys for forest ecosystems, wildlife, freshwater fishes, insects, and high conservation value (HCV) areas.
- Forest Management & Firefighting: Knowledgeable in forest resource planning, fire prevention and suppression techniques, and forest pest/disease monitoring.
- Research & Reporting: Experienced in designing research protocols, data curation, and producing technical reports and management plans.
- Project & Financial Management: Competent in planning, budgeting, monitoring, and reporting for national and international conservation projects.
- Gender Mainstreaming: Experienced in integrating gender considerations into community forestry and conservation programs.

Soft Skills

- Communication: Effective in presenting technical information to stakeholders, communities, and government authorities.
- Teamwork & Collaboration: Experienced in coordinating multidisciplinary teams and inter-agency initiatives.
- Leadership & Capacity Building: Skilled in leading projects, policy implementation, and training programs at divisional and national levels.

Awards & Achievements

Scholarships

- Recipient of RGoB Scholarship for B.Sc. in Forestry (2015 – 2019) at College of Natural Resources, Bhutan



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Academic Awards

- Recognized for outstanding research in “*Diversity and Distribution of Coccinellids under Different Habitats in Zhemgang Dzongkhag*” during B.Sc. Forestry program; secured second position overall in the B.Sc. programme.
- Reciepiant of His Majesty’s Certificate for topping the 1st year of B.Sc. Forestry program.

Professional Recognition

- Appointed as a Commissioned Officer by the Royal Civil Service Commission (RCSC) in 2020.
- Recognized as Outstanding Official for Three Consecutive Years (2023 – 2025) for exemplary performance and contributions in forestry and conservation.

Referees:

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